

1 Project Overview & Methodology

In this project I focused on **Henrik Knibergs “Making Sense of MVP”** model and follows the

Skateboard → Scooter → Bicycle → Motorcycle → Car metaphor

The idea is about building the **earliest possible playable version** first and incrementally improving it, instead of developing a huge ambitious project where components serve only the end outcome.

1.1 Skateboard (Week 1) – Console Prototype

The first step was to create a minimal but playable version of the game. A German dictionary was sourced and processed using a Java helper class to filter valid **5-letter words**.

At this stage, the following functionality was implemented:

- Dictionary loading
- User input handling
- Validation against the dictionary

1.2 Scooter (Week 2) – Core Game Logic

In week 2, a fully working **terminal-based Wordle game** was implemented. This included:

- Random target word selection
- Attempt tracking
- Letter-by-letter feedback using **G / Y / B**
- Win and lose conditions

1.3 Bicycle (Week 3) – Web Version

In week 3, the existing game logic was integrated into a web application using:

- Java with Javalin for the backend
- HTML, CSS, and JavaScript for the frontend

1.4 Motorcycle (Week 4) – UX, Testing & Deployment

In week 4, the project was refined and stabilized:

- UI improvements using modals
- Improved user feedback
- Basic unit tests using JUnit
- Deployment of the application

1.5 Car - Final Polish (Week 5)

The final phase focuses on:

- UX refinements
- Code cleanup
- Documentation improvements

Key Takeaway

The main goal was to always maintain a **working and playable version** and improve it incrementally, fully aligned with the MVP mindset.